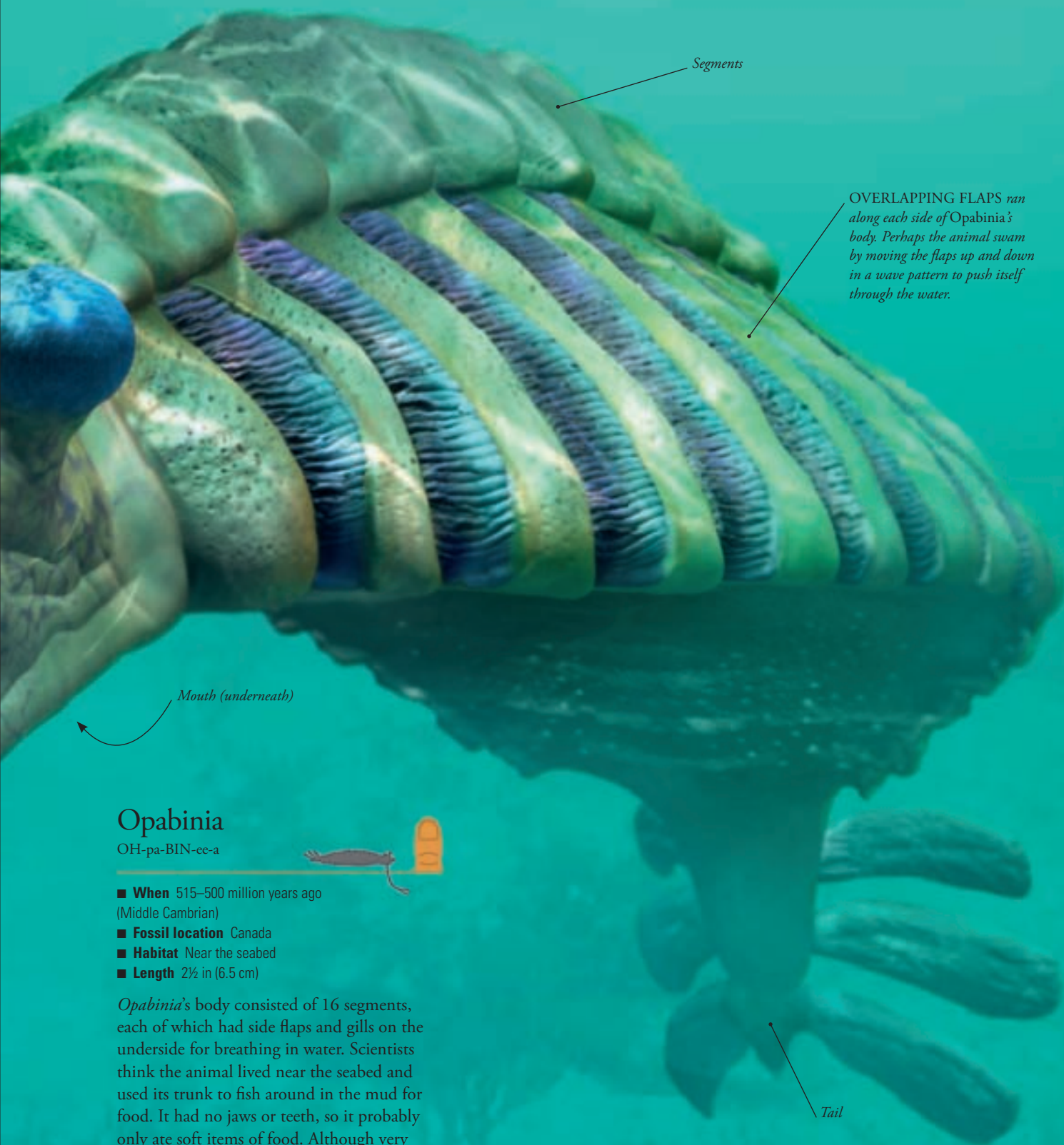




Opabinia

OH-pa-BIN-ee-a



- **When** 515–500 million years ago (Middle Cambrian)
- **Fossil location** Canada
- **Habitat** Near the seabed
- **Length** 2½ in (6.5 cm)

Opabinia's body consisted of 16 segments, each of which had side flaps and gills on the underside for breathing in water. Scientists think the animal lived near the seabed and used its trunk to fish around in the mud for food. It had no jaws or teeth, so it probably only ate soft items of food. Although very different from all other living or prehistoric animals, *Opabinia* is thought to be related to the arthropods (invertebrates with jointed limbs and external skeletons, such as insects, spiders, and crabs).

